
GODS, SACRED BEINGS AND THEIR STORIES

A Complete Index of Divine Figures Across the Haligrity Library — By Culture

Every tradition in this library
understood the divine
through specific faces and specific stories.
The diversity of divine expression
is not evidence of many gods
or of confused theology.
It is the evidence of one sacred reality
finding its face in every culture
it has ever inhabited.
The names change.
The thunder does not.

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AZTEC / MEXICA

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Omeyotl	Dual Creator — the non-dual divine	The Two-God: simultaneously male and female, light and dark. Exists at Omeyocan (the Place of Duality), the thirteenth heaven. Never depicted, never given a temple — the divine beyond form. Father-Mother of all the gods.
Huitzilopochtli	God of war and the sun; patron deity of the Mexica	Born each dawn from the body of the earth — defeating his siblings (the stars, led by Coyolxauhqui the moon) to rise again. The daily solar journey as cosmic battle. Requires the offering of human blood to sustain his victory.
Quetzalcoatl	Feathered Serpent; god of wind, Venus, wisdom, sacred arts	The civilizing deity who brought writing, calendar knowledge, and the arts to humanity. His departure and prophesied return shaped Aztec political history. The morning and evening star — Venus — is his celestial form.
Tezcatlipoca (Black)	God of night, fate, sorcery, and the earth	The Smoking Mirror — his obsidian mirror reflects the truth of what is. Engaged in eternal cosmic conflict with Quetzalcoatl. Omniscient, unpredictable, the principle of sacred chaos that keeps creation from stagnation.
Xipe Totec	God of renewal; the Red Tezcatlipoca	The Flayed God — representing the earth shedding its skin to reveal new life beneath. His priests wore the skins of sacrificed persons for twenty days — the seed bursting its casing, the new growth emerging from the discarded outer form.
Tlaloc	God of rain, water, lightning, and agricultural fertility	His distinctive goggle-eyed appearance in art spans 1,500 years of Mesoamerican history — one of the most ancient Mesoamerican deities. The mountains are his realm; rain is his gift. Children were specifically offered to him at the opening of the rainy season.
Coatlicue	Earth Mother; goddess of life, death, and rebirth	Her skirt of serpents, her necklace of hearts and hands, her clawed feet — she is the earth's totality, consuming and generating simultaneously. The mother of Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and the four hundred star brothers.
Coyolxauhqui	Moon goddess; Huitzilopochtli's sister	Led the four hundred star brothers in attacking their mother Coatlicue when she became pregnant. Huitzilopochtli was born fully armed and dismembered Coyolxauhqui — her body rolling down the hill of Coatepec. The Great Temple in Tenochtitlan's base stone depicts her dismembered body.

BASQUE

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Mari	Supreme Goddess — the oldest surviving goddess of storms, mountains, truth, and the sacred feminine	Lives in specific caves in the highest peaks of the Pyrenees. Creates storms when she travels. Associated with the oak tree and the power of truth. She who cannot be lied to. The most ancient surviving female supreme deity in Western Europe.
Sugaar / Maju	Serpent god; Mari's consort; god of the earth's interior	A serpent deity who lives in the earth's interior. When Mari and Sugaar meet periodically, their union creates storms. The earth's fertility is their love.
Basajaun	Lord of the Forest	A massive wild being covered in hair who lives in the deep forest. Simultaneously dangerous and protective — when he calls out, the flocks gather for protection. He taught early humans agriculture and metallurgy. The Basque origin of the Wild Man archetype.
Urtzi / Ortzi	Sky god; thunder deity	Preserved in the Euskara word for sky (zerua). Less prominent than Mari in the surviving tradition but present in the fundamental Basque sacred vocabulary.
Laminak	Water fairies; female supernatural beings at springs and rivers	Associated with spinning, weaving, and the liminal zones between the human and sacred worlds. Can be helpful or dangerous depending on how they are treated. The Basque expression of the European fairy tradition.

CANAANITE

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
El	Father of Gods and Men; Supreme Creator	The gray-bearded, benevolent, wine-holding elder who presides over the divine assembly. Dwells at the source of the two rivers. His name becomes the Hebrew generic word for God — and the root of Allah.
Asherah (Athirat)	Mother Goddess; Sea Goddess; El's consort; Queen of Heaven	Mother of the gods, including Baal. Archaeological evidence confirms she was worshipped in ancient Israel alongside YHWH — asherah poles stood in temples. Her systematic removal from the Hebrew religious record is one of the most significant acts of theological revision in history.
Baal Hadad	Storm God; most active Canaanite deity; bringer of rain	The Baal Cycle tells the story: Baal defeats Yam (the Sea/Chaos) with two sacred clubs made by the divine craftsman Kothar-wa-Khasis. He then builds his palace. Mot (Death) challenges him. The cycle of Baal's death and resurrection maps directly onto the agricultural year.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Anat	Warrior Goddess; Baal's sister	One of the most ferocious divine figures in any tradition — she goes into battle wearing the heads of enemies as a belt. Simultaneously the protector of her brother Baal and the embodiment of the sacred violence that maintains cosmic order.
Mot	God of Death; Lord of the Underworld	Not a villain — the necessary counterpart of Baal in the cosmic order. Mot demands that Baal descend to his realm. When Baal dies, the rain stops and the earth dries. Anat's vengeance against Mot restores the cycle.
Yam	God of the Sea; Primordial Chaos	Before Baal's rise to prominence, Yam demanded submission from the divine assembly. Baal's victory over Yam is the establishment of order from chaos — the foundational Canaanite cosmological act.
Kothar-wa-Khasis	Divine Craftsman; God of Arts and Crafts	The Canaanite divine craftsman equivalent to the Greek Hephaestus — maker of the weapons that enable Baal's victories. His name means "Skillful and Wise."

DOGON (Mali, West Africa)

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Amma	Supreme Creator; sky god	The cosmic egg from whose opening all creation emerged. Amma's first creative acts were imperfect — his union with the earth (Yasigui) produced the Jackal (chaos) before the Nommo could be born. The universe's origin contains within it the sacred imperfection that makes creation dynamic.
The Nommo	Sacred water beings; celestial ancestors; bringers of civilization	Eight primordial water beings who descended to earth in the first ark. Amphibious, fish-tailed, serpentine. They brought the sacred technologies of weaving, speech, and sacred geometry. The Dogon's detailed knowledge of Sirius B (Sirius's invisible companion star, only confirmed by Western astronomy in 1970) is attributed to Nommo contact. The most debated sacred knowledge transmission in the world.
Lébé	First human to die; ancestor of all ancestors	Swallowed by Amma and reborn as a serpent — the first ancestor's resurrection as the sacred connection between the living and the ancestral realm. His body was reborn in serpent form, and the earth where he was buried holds his sacred bones.
The Pale Fox (Ogo / Jackal)	The principle of sacred disorder; trickster; divination	The imperfect first creation — born of Amma's flawed union. His footprints in the divination sand (the Sigi So system) reveal the sacred pattern of what is to come. Chaos as necessary participant in creation.

EGYPTIAN (Ancient Kemet)

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Ra (Amun-Ra)	Sun God; Supreme Creator	The sun's daily journey across the sky is Ra's sacred voyage — through the sky in the solar barque, through the underworld at night, defeating Apep (the serpent of chaos) to rise again each dawn. Creation itself is Ra's first self-creation from the primordial waters (Nun).
Osiris	God of the Afterlife; Resurrection; Sacred Kingship	Osiris was killed by his brother Set, who dismembered his body and scattered the pieces. Isis gathered the pieces, reconstituted the body, and conceived Horus through the restored Osiris. The first resurrection. The model for all death-and-rebirth narrative in Western sacred tradition.
Isis	Goddess of Magic, Healing, and Motherhood	The most universally worshipped goddess in the ancient world — her cult spread from Egypt throughout the Roman Empire. Her magic reconstituted Osiris. Her protection sheltered the young Horus. She is the model of sacred feminine intelligence: not power over, but power through complete understanding.
Horus	God of the Sky; Sacred Kingship; the Living Pharaoh	Born of Isis and the reconstituted Osiris — he grew up to claim his father's throne from Set. The battle between Horus and Set is the cosmic maintenance of sacred order against chaos. Every pharaoh was the living Horus; at death, became the living Osiris.
Thoth (Tehuti)	God of Writing, Wisdom, and Sacred Knowledge; the Divine Scribe	The ibis-headed or baboon-headed deity who invented hieroglyphs, maintained the sacred records, and served as mediator between the warring divine forces. Identified with Hermes Trismegistus in the Hermetic tradition — the bridge between Egyptian wisdom and Greek philosophy.
Ma'at	Goddess of Truth, Justice, and Cosmic Order	Ma'at is simultaneously a goddess and the fundamental principle of cosmic order — the feather against which the heart is weighed in the Hall of Two Truths. Her name means "that which is straight." The universe runs on Ma'at; without it, the cosmos returns to chaos.
Anubis	God of Embalming and the Dead	The jackal-headed god who guides souls through the underworld and who oversees the weighing of the heart. The protector of graves. He who presides over the moment of transition and ensures the deceased has what they need for the journey.
Set	God of Chaos, Storms, and the Desert	Not a simple villain — Set killed Osiris but also protects Ra's solar barque from the serpent Apep each night. Without Set's ferocity, Ra would not survive. The sacred principle of chaos as necessary for creation.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Sekhmet	Goddess of War, Healing, and the Sun's destructive power	The lion-headed goddess whose rage, once unleashed, almost destroyed humanity — Ra had to trick her with beer dyed red with pomegranate juice to stop the slaughter. The same force that destroys is the force that heals. Sekhmet's priests were the most skilled physicians in the ancient world.
Hathor	Goddess of Love, Beauty, Music, and Joy	The cow-headed or cow-eared goddess who receives the dead in the West, who nurses the living pharaoh, who brings music and intoxication as sacred gifts. She who holds the mirror of self-knowledge.

GREEK MYSTERIES

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Zeus	King of the Gods; Lord of the Sky; Sacred Order	The organizing principle of the divine — not the ultimate divine (the Fates stand above him). His lightning is sacred law made visible. His many unions with mortals and goddesses produce the heroes and demigods who inhabit the mythological world.
Demeter	Goddess of the Harvest and Sacred Law	Her daughter Persephone was taken to the underworld by Hades while gathering flowers. Demeter's grief stopped all growth — winter. The return of Persephone in spring is the explanation of the agricultural cycle and the sacred knowledge at the heart of the Eleusinian Mysteries.
Persephone	Queen of the Underworld; Goddess of Spring	The story of Persephone's descent and return is the foundational death-and-rebirth narrative of Greek sacred tradition. She alone moves between worlds. At Eleusis, initiates experienced her journey — the terror of descent and the revelation of return.
Dionysus	God of Wine, Ecstasy, and Sacred Madness	Born twice — once from his mother Semele (who was destroyed by Zeus's full divine presence) and again from Zeus's thigh. His twice-born nature makes him the god of transformation through dissolution. The Dionysian Mysteries: becoming the god through sacred intoxication and release of self.
Orpheus	Sacred Singer; Descender to the Underworld	The musician whose singing moved rocks and rivers, who descended to the underworld to retrieve his wife Eurydice, who looked back and lost her — and whose grief, transformed into sacred song, became the foundation of the Orphic tradition.
Hermes	God of Boundaries, Travelers, and Sacred Transmission	The messenger of the gods — the one who can cross between worlds (the only Olympian who moves freely between the living world, Olympus, and the underworld). The principle of sacred transmission: what cannot be carried directly must be carried by Hermes.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Apollo	God of the Sun, Music, Prophecy, and Healing	The archer who can both send plague and heal it — both the agent of disease and the healer. His oracle at Delphi was the most important sacred site in the Greek world. Know thyself: Apollo's sacred instruction.
Athena	Goddess of Wisdom and Craft	Born fully armed from Zeus's head — wisdom arising complete from the depths of the mind. Patron of Athens. The sacred feminine as intelligence and strategic clarity rather than destruction or fertility.
Hecate	Goddess of Magic, Crossroads, and the Moon's dark face	The torchbearer at the crossroads — the goddess who was present when Persephone was taken, who carries light through the underworld. Associated with magic, necromancy, and the knowledge of liminal spaces. Invoked at crossroads at night, with offerings left at three-way intersections.

HINDU (Primary Deities)

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Brahman	Ultimate Reality — not a deity but the ground of all existence	The non-dual absolute from which all manifestation arises and to which it returns. Not worshipped because there is no distance from which to worship. Advaita Vedanta's Brahman = the Atman (individual soul). The philosophical heart of Haligrity: there is only this.
Brahma	Creator God	The creator of the universe — one of the Trimurti alongside Vishnu and Shiva. Despite being the creator, paradoxically has very few temples in modern India. His creative work is finished; what continues requires Vishnu to preserve and Shiva to dissolve.
Vishnu	The Preserver; the one who maintains cosmic order	He descends into the world in specific incarnations (avatars) whenever the divine order is threatened. Ten primary avatars: Matsya, Kurma, Varaha, Narasimha, Vamana, Parashurama, Rama, Krishna, Buddha, Kalki (yet to come).
Krishna	8th Avatar of Vishnu; God of Love, Compassion, and Divine Wisdom	The Bhagavad Gita is his teaching to Arjuna on the battlefield of Kurukshetra — on duty, devotion, the nature of the self, and the path to liberation. His life is the most beloved story in the Hindu tradition: the sacred child, the divine lover, the sacred warrior-teacher.
Shiva	The Destroyer and Transformer; Lord of Yoga	The destroyer whose destruction enables new creation — he dances the universe into dissolution in his Nataraja form. Simultaneously the ascetic sitting in meditation on Mount Kailash and the lover with Parvati. Lord of Yoga, of time, of death, of liberation.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Shakti / Devi	The Divine Feminine; the power without which Shiva cannot act	The goddess in her multiple forms — as Parvati (Shiva's consort), as Durga (the warrior goddess who defeats the buffalo demon Mahishasura), as Kali (the destroyer of ego), as Saraswati (knowledge), as Lakshmi (abundance). Shakti is not separate from Brahman — she is its dynamic, creative, manifesting face.
Ganesha	Remover of Obstacles; God of Beginnings	The elephant-headed son of Shiva and Parvati — honored first in all Hindu ceremonies. His elephant head carries the wisdom of memory; his large ears filter what matters from what doesn't; his trunk distinguishes between fine and coarse.
Lakshmi	Goddess of Abundance, Beauty, and Prosperity	Emerged from the churning of the cosmic ocean (Samudra Manthan) — she is the divine grace that flows toward those who cultivate the inner conditions for her presence. She does not stay where she is not honored.
Saraswati	Goddess of Knowledge, Arts, and Learning	Brahma's consort. The white-robed goddess seated on a white lotus, holding the veena — music as the vehicle of sacred knowledge. Associated with the invisible sacred river Saraswati that flows beneath the visible world.
Kali	Goddess of Time, Death, and Liberation	She who devours time itself — her dark skin represents the void before creation, her lolling tongue the taste of what she has consumed, her garland of severed heads the ego-deaths required for liberation. She is not to be feared; she is to be understood.
Hanuman	The Divine Servant; God of Devotion and Strength	The monkey god who serves Rama with absolute devotion — he leaped across the ocean to reach Lanka, he carried the mountain of healing herbs. His strength comes entirely from his bhakti (sacred devotion). The model of selfless sacred service.
Durga	Warrior Goddess; destroyer of demons; sacred feminine power	The combined force of all the male deities' power, given female form to defeat what they could not. Her ten arms each carry a weapon given by a different god. She rides a lion. Her nine-night festival (Navratri) is one of the most important in the Hindu calendar.

INUIT / ARCTIC PEOPLES

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Sedna	Goddess of the Sea and Sea Creatures	Thrown into the ocean by her father or husband — her fingers were cut off as she tried to climb back into the boat. Each joint became a different sea creature. She is the keeper of all sea life; angering her means the animals withdraw.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Sila	Spirit of Air, Weather, and Cosmic Intelligence	Not a deity in the anthropomorphic sense — Sila is the intelligence of the living cosmos, the awareness that pervades all things. Present in every breath. The most fundamental Inuit sacred concept: the universe is conscious, and that consciousness is felt as air.

MŌRĪ

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Ranginui	Sky Father	Locked in embrace with Papatūmuku (Earth Mother) — their union was so complete that their children lived in darkness between them until Tāne Mahuta separated them. The sky's tears as rain are his longing for the earth.
Papatūmuku	Earth Mother	The earth itself is her body. Her embrace with Ranginui was so complete that their children had no light until they were separated. Her sighs rise as mist. Her body is the land — and the Mōri sacred relationship with land as ancestor begins here.
Tāne Mahuta	God of Forests and Birds; Creator of Humans	He who separated his parents — pushing Ranginui upward to create space for life. Creator of the first human woman (Hineahuone) from earth. Father of the birds. Lord of the forest whose domain is sacred in every tree.
Tangaroa	God of the Sea and Aquatic Life	The ocean is his domain — all fish, all sea creatures are his children. His relationship with Tāne (forest) is one of sacred tension; fish hooks come from wood, nets from flax.
Tū (Tūmatauenga)	God of People and War	When the children of Ranginui and Papatūmuku debated how to deal with their parents, only Tū argued for separation. He became the god of humans — who must struggle and fight to survive.
Rongo	God of Peace and Cultivated Plants	The atua of kōmara (sweet potato), the most sacred food plant, and of all cultivated foods. Under his protection, the tapu of war is lifted and peace is possible.
Māui	The Trickster Demigod; Fisher of Islands	The youngest of his siblings, born premature and cast into the sea wrapped in his mother's topknot. Rescued by the sky ancestor. He fished up the North Island of New Zealand, slowed the sun, brought fire from the underworld, and died attempting to win immortality for humans.
Hine-nui-te-pō	Goddess of Death and the Night	Originally Hineahuone's daughter, she ascended to the underworld and became its ruler — the first human to become a divine being through transformation. It is in her hands that Māui died, crushed while attempting to enter her body to secure immortality.

MESOPOTAMIAN (Sumerian / Babylonian)

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
An (Anu)	Sky God; Father of the Gods	The most ancient Sumerian supreme deity — the personification of heaven itself. Father of Enlil and Enki. His authority is the original divine authority from which all others derive.
Enlil	God of Wind, Air, and Earth; Lord of Storms	The most powerful active deity in the early Sumerian tradition. He separated heaven and earth. He decreed the flood that destroyed humanity. Unpredictable, powerful, sovereign over the breath of life and the storm of destruction.
Enki (Ea)	God of Wisdom, Water, and the Sacred Arts	The most compassionate of the major Mesopotamian deities — consistently the one who warns humans of divine plans and teaches them the arts of civilization. He warned Utnapishtim of the flood. He created humanity twice. The sacred trickster-helper.
Inanna (Ishtar)	Goddess of Love, War, Political Power, and Venus	The Descent of Inanna: she descended to the underworld (Kur), ruled by her sister Ereshkigal, stripping away her divine attributes at each of the seven gates. She died, hung on a hook, for three days. Then rose. The oldest written death-and-resurrection narrative. Inanna's influence on Persephone, Isis, and Mary is direct and documented.
Nanna (Sin)	Moon God	The primary deity of the sacred city of Ur — the moon god whose nightly journey across the sky brought the sacred measurement of time. Father of Inanna and Utu (Shamash).
Utu (Shamash)	Sun God; God of Justice	The sun whose light reveals all hidden things — the god of justice who sees everything. Hammurabi received the sacred law code from Shamash. Justice and the solar eye are inseparable.
Nergal	God of the Underworld and Plague	Ruler of the Mesopotamian underworld alongside Ereshkigal. Initially he was a sky deity who descended to the underworld and seized power from Ereshkigal — then married her. The underworld has two rulers; its governance is a marriage of forces.
Ereshkigal	Queen of the Great Below; Goddess of the Underworld	Inanna's sister and ruler of the underworld. When Inanna descends and arrives naked and bowed low, Ereshkigal's judgment kills her. The sister who rules death is not evil — she is the other face of the divine feminine, the part that knows what cannot be known while alive.
Marduk	Supreme God of Babylon	The Enuma Elish tells his story: he defeated Tiamat (the primordial chaos dragon) by cutting her body in two — one half became the sky, the other the earth. From the blood of Tiamat's general Kingu, he created humanity. He who defeats chaos creates the world.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Gilgamesh	King of Uruk; 2/3 Divine Hero	The Epic of Gilgamesh: two-thirds divine, one-third human. His friendship with the wild man Enkidu. The death of Enkidu and Gilgamesh's search for immortality. His meeting with Utnapishtim, who survived the flood. His return with the plant of rejuvenation, which a serpent steals. The first great epic literature is a meditation on death, friendship, and the sacred acceptance of mortality.
Utnapishtim	The Mesopotamian Flood Survivor; the immortal	Warned by Enki about the gods' decision to send the flood, Utnapishtim built a boat and survived. Given immortality by the gods. He told Gilgamesh where the plant of rejuvenation grows. The Mesopotamian Noah — and older than Noah.

NORSE

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Odin (Allfather)	God of Wisdom, War, Magic, Death, and Poetry	He sacrificed one eye to drink from Mimir's well of wisdom. He hung himself on Yggdrasil (the World Tree) for nine days and nine nights to receive the runes. He sends his ravens Huginn (Thought) and Muninn (Memory) out each day to gather knowledge. The wisdom god as the one who has paid for everything he knows.
Thor	God of Thunder, Strength, and Protection of Midgard	The wielder of Mjölner (the sacred hammer) — the specific weapon that defends the human world from the jotnar (giants) who would consume it. Thor's popularity among the Norse was greater than Odin's — Odin is the god of kings and skalds, but Thor protects everyone.
Loki	The Trickster; Agent of Change and Disruption	Born a frost giant but adopted by the Aesir — his mixed nature makes him both indispensable and destructive. He fathers the monsters: Fenrir (the wolf), Jörmungandr (the world serpent), Hel (ruler of the dead). He causes Baldr's death. At Ragnarök, he leads the attack against the gods. Chaos that once served creation now consumes it.
Freya	Goddess of Love, War, Magic, and Death	She receives half of all who die in battle (Odin receives the other half) — her realm Fólkvangr holds her share of the honored dead. She weeps golden tears for her missing husband Óðr. She is the greatest of the Vanir, the first to teach the Aesir seidr magic.
Baldr	God of Light and the Beloved	The most beloved of the Aesir — beautiful, wise, and kind. His death was arranged by Loki using mistletoe (the one thing Frigg forgot to make swear not to harm him). His death is the beginning of Ragnarök's inevitability. The beloved who must die so the new world can be born.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Tyr	God of Justice and Sacred Law	He sacrificed his hand to bind the Fenrir wolf — placing it in the wolf's mouth as a pledge while the gods pretended to bind him. When Fenrir discovered he was truly bound, he bit off Tyr's hand. Tyr accepted this loss because binding Fenrir was necessary. Justice requires sacrifice.
Frigg	Queen of the Aesir; Goddess of Foresight, Marriage, and Motherhood	Odin's wife. She knows the fate of all beings but does not speak of it — the divine feminine as the keeper of what must not yet be said. She made every thing in the nine worlds swear not to harm Baldr, except the mistletoe.

SLAVIC PAGANISM

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Perun	God of Thunder, Justice, and the Sacred Oak	The supreme active deity of the Slavic sacred world — the thunder god who engages in eternal battle with Veles. His weapons are lightning bolts; his sacred tree is the oak. When thunder sounds, Perun is pursuing Veles who has stolen cattle or souls.
Veles	God of the Underworld, Cattle, Magic, and the Arts	The eternal opponent of Perun — but not a simple villain. Veles governs the underworld, the waters, the dead, and sacred knowledge. He is the lord of what lives beneath and within. The cattle he steals from Perun's realm are the rain clouds.
Mokosh	Earth Mother; Goddess of Fate, Water, and Women's Work	The only major female deity in the primary Slavic pantheon — she governs the earth's fertility, the spinning and weaving of fate, and the sacred work of women. Her sacred animal is the sheep; her domain is the spindle.
Svarog	God of Fire and the Sky; the Divine Smith	The sky god and sacred craftsman — equivalent to the Greek Hephaestus. He made the sacred tongs that pulled the first fire from the sky. Father of Svarozhich (the sacred hearth fire) and Dazbog (the sun).
Marzanna (Morana)	Goddess of Winter, Death, and Disease	The goddess of winter who must be expelled every spring — her straw effigy drowned or burned in the Marzanna ceremony as the formal ceremonial end of winter. She returns every autumn.
Rod and the Rozhanitsy	Creator; Fate Weavers	Rod is the primordial creator — the most ancient of the Slavic divine beings. The Rozhanitsy (often appearing as the two Fates, Rod's daughters) weave the sacred threads of destiny at the moment of birth.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Baba Yaga	The Forest Witch; Guardian of the Threshold Between Worlds	Lives in the deep forest in a house on chicken legs that turns its back to visitors (requiring the sacred phrase: "Turn your back to the forest, your front to me"). She may help or devour — the outcome depends on whether the hero knows how to approach her. The guardian of sacred knowledge who tests those who seek it.

YORUBA / WEST AFRICAN

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Olodumare (Olurun)	Supreme Creator; the Ultimate Reality	Not approached directly — the supreme divine behind all the Orishas. Too complete and vast for the human mind to approach without intermediaries. The Orishas are the faces through which Olodumare is experienced.
Obatala	Father of the Orishas; Creator of Human Bodies	Olodumare assigned Obatala the task of creating human bodies from clay. He began drinking palm wine during the work and created deformed bodies — this is why some humans are born with physical differences. He is their patron. He who creates imperfectly is also the one who must honor what he has made.
Eshu (Elegba)	Orisha of the Crossroads and Communication	The first Orisha to be called in any ceremony — no other Orisha can be reached without his permission. Trickster, messenger, opener of roads, guardian of all thresholds. The crossroads is his sacred space. He must be honored first; otherwise communication with the divine is blocked.
Shango	Orisha of Thunder, Lightning, and Justice	The fourth king of Oyo who became an Orisha — he who can call lightning from the sky. He represents sacred justice made visible as thunder: what is wrong will be struck. His colors are red and white; his symbol is the double-headed axe.
Yemoja (Yemanjá)	Orisha of the Ocean and Motherhood	The mother of all Orishas — she whose waters gave birth to everything. Her name means "mother whose children are like fish" — countless. She receives those who are lost at sea. Her blue and crystal colors are the colors of the deep water.
Oshun	Orisha of Fresh Water, Love, and Beauty	The Orisha of the river — her domain is fresh water, romantic love, beauty, and prosperity. The sweetness in life. The river as the path of what flows freely. When Oshun withdrew in anger, the world dried.
Ogun	Orisha of Iron, War, Labor, and Technology	The Orisha invoked by anyone who works with metal or metal tools — he governs the sacred technology of transformation. Surgeons, soldiers, mechanics, and blacksmiths are all under his domain. He is the one who clears the path with his machete.

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
Oya	Orisha of Wind, Storms, Change, and Death	The warrior queen who accompanies Shango into battle — she governs the wind that changes everything, the marketplace, and the gates of the cemetery. Change itself is sacred. She is the one who sweeps the old away so the new can arrive.
Orunmila (Ifa)	Orisha of Wisdom and Divination	The keeper of the 256 Odù — the sacred corpus of Ifá wisdom. He was present at the moment of creation and witnessed each soul's choice of destiny before birth. Divination with Ifá is the process of remembering what was chosen and aligning with it.

PAN-TRADITION SYNTHESIS (Universal Archetypes)

DIVINE BEING	DOMAIN / ROLE	SACRED STORY / FABLE
The Thunder God	Universal archetype across all traditions	Perkūnas (Lithuanian), Thor (Norse), Perun (Slavic), Indra (Hindu), Shango (Yoruba), Baal (Canaanite), Zeus (Greek), Taranis (Celtic). The same sacred reality — divine power made visible in storm. Every tradition that has experienced thunder has understood it as the voice of the sacred.
The Descent and Return Goddess	Universal archetype of death and resurrection	Inanna (Sumerian), Persephone (Greek), Isis (Egyptian), Durga (Hindu), Oya (Yoruba). The feminine divine who descends to the underworld and returns — bringing with her the sacred knowledge that only death can teach. The agricultural year as her body.
The Divine Trickster	Universal archetype of sacred chaos and necessary disruption	Loki (Norse), Anansi (Akan), Eshu/Elegba (Yoruba), Coyote (Native American), Hermes (Greek), the Pale Fox (Dogon). The one who disrupts the system from within — not out of malice, but because disruption is how systems grow.
The Divine Mother	Universal archetype of sacred feminine generativity	Coatlicue (Aztec), Papatōnuku (Māori), Mokosh (Slavic), Asherah (Canaanite), Devi/Shakti (Hindu), Yemoja (Yoruba), Mari (Basque). Every tradition has understood the earth as a mother — and honored the generativity that sustains all life.

The names change. Inanna and Persephone both descend to the underworld and return. Perun and Baal both battle the underworld power in every storm. The divine feminine appears as Mari in the Basque mountains, as Asherah in the Canaanite groves, as Devi in the Hindu tradition, as Yemoja in the Yoruba ocean, as Papatōnuku in the Māori earth. The thunder god is Perkūnas and Thor and Indra and Shango and Baal — one divine reality finding its face in every culture it has ever inhabited. The diversity of divine expression is evidence of the breadth of the sacred, not of confusion. Ahshee.